SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

25 July 2022 · Shift 3

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The peanut stove, which is so often seen on the _____, just outside the fruit-shops, makes us think of the familiar street scene at home.

(A) Runway
(B) Building
(C) Market
(D) Footpath

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Yesterday, I _____ to be on a street with a few modest restaurants.

(A) happened
(B) have happen
(C) am happening
(D) happening

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. You better “gird up your loins” as we are going to meet my family.

(A) To earn more money
(B) To look smart and charming
(C) To prepare oneself for a difficult situation
(D) To ask for someone’s help

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Three hours should be _____ to finish the work.

(A) majestic
(B) voluminous
(C) sufficient
(D) grand

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I walked out _____ I wanted to breathe some fresh air.

(A) but
(B) that
(C) because
(D) yet

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. He knows “how bad” I wanted a baby.

(A) how badly
(B) what bad
(C) No improvement required
(D) badly how

Q.7

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them contains an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. The thin wire that giving off light is called the filament.

(A) that giving off
(B) the filament
(C) The thin wire
(D) light is called

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Many celebrities "encourage" young children to aspire for greatness.

(A) daunt
(B) stimulate
(C) undermine
(D) abate

Q.9

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Livelyhood
(B) Verittable
(C) Purposfully
(D) Penetrate

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Emphatic

(A) Vigorous
(B) Restrained
(C) Hesitant
(D) Moderate

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An unlikely chance or occurrence, especially a piece of good luck

(A) Pauper
(B) Messiah
(C) Fluke
(D) Masquerade

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I want to enrol myself for this management _____.

(A) cause
(B) caws
(C) course
(D) coarse

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The range of flavours is determined by where the plant species is grown and how "it is processed."

(A) it was processing
(B) it is processing
(C) No substitution required
(D) it was processed

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. An eye opener

(A) A tough decision
(B) A shocking revelation
(C) A difficult task
(D) A small opening

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A _____ girl is missing from my Colony.

(A) less
(B) so
(C) little
(D) few

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Obscure

(A) Obvious
(B) Complementary
(C) Moody
(D) Difficult

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. I initially thought of including both the mother and the child, but the woman was reluctant to have their pictures take.

(A) both the mother and the child, but the woman
(B) was reluctant to have their pictures take
(C) I initially thought of including
(D) No error

Q.19

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. We needing to kept / a close eye on / the rising prices of fuel.

(A) We needing to kept
(B) the rising prices of fuel
(C) No error
(D) a close eye on

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Farmers are urged to _____ to good agricultural practices in the disposal and spreading of agricultural wastes such as slurry.

(A) Adhere
(B) Disturb
(C) Gather
(D) Worship

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In order to fall asleep (1) _____ night, strive to turn off all electronic devices at least 30 minutes (2) _____ getting into bed. Allow your eyes to relax and take a break from the (3) _____ of a lit screen. Read a book, write in a journal, or write (4) _____ your to-do list for the (5) _____ day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) in
(B) into
(C) at
(D) to

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In order to fall asleep (1) _____ night, strive to turn off all electronic devices at least 30 minutes (2) _____ getting into bed. Allow your eyes to relax and take a break from the (3) _____ of a lit screen. Read a book, write in a journal, or write (4) _____ your to-do list for the (5) _____ day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) former
(B) before
(C) previous
(D) latter

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In order to fall asleep (1) _____ night, strive to turn off all electronic devices at least 30 minutes (2) _____ getting into bed. Allow your eyes to relax and take a break from the (3) _____ of a lit screen. Read a book, write in a journal, or write (4) _____ your to-do list for the (5) _____ day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) on
(B) down
(C) of
(D) onto

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In order to fall asleep (1) _____ night, strive to turn off all electronic devices at least 30 minutes (2) _____ getting into bed. Allow your eyes to relax and take a break from the (3) _____ of a lit screen. Read a book, write in a journal, or write (4) _____ your to-do list for the (5) _____ day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) present
(B) previous
(C) following
(D) preceding

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 6 ÷ 24 + 6 × 7 – 5 = 29

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) ÷ and +
(C) ÷ and –
(D) × and +

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: All brothers are sisters. Statement II: All sisters are wives and all wives are sons. Conclusion I: All brothers are sons. Conclusion II: Some sons are wives.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(B) Both conclusions I and II follows.
(C) Only conclusion II follows.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'CRICKET' is written as 'FULFNHW', 'STYLE' is written as 'VWBOH' and 'RISE' is written as 'ULVH'. What is the code for the word 'GO' in that code language?

(A) IQ
(B) IR
(C) JR
(D) DL

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. TON : YTS :: LAR : ?

(A) REW
(B) RFW
(C) QEW
(D) QFW

Q.5

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 31, 41, 55, 73, 95, ?

(A) 121
(B) 111
(C) 123
(D) 143

Q.7

Among five friends, Puneet, Qazir, Raman, Suresh and Tinku, Tinku is shorter than only one friend. Raman is the tallest among all the friends. Qazir is taller than only one person. Only two persons are shorter than Puneet. Who is the shortest among all the friends?

(A) Puneet
(B) Suresh
(C) Tinku
(D) Qazir

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No X is C.II. Some A are C. Conclusions: I. Some C are not X. II. Some A are X is a possibility. III. All C are A.

(A) Only conclusions I and II follow
(B) All the conclusions follow
(C) Only conclusions II and III follow
(D) Only conclusion III follows

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 16 : 49 :: 18 : 55 :: 36 : ?

(A) 119
(B) 109
(C) 107
(D) 113

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'HORNS' is written as 'SLIMH', and 'PIRTA' is written as 'KRIGZ'. How will 'SONG' be written in that language?

(A) HLNT
(B) HLOS
(C) HMLS
(D) HLMT

Q.12

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GRAM, EPYK, CNWI, ?

(A) AMVH
(B) AMUG
(C) ALUG
(D) ALVG

Q.14

Six friends, Himan, Bablu, Manoj, Erica, Pawan and Chaman, are sitting in two rows facing each other, with three friends in each row. Himan and Chaman are in the same row but are not neighbours. Bablu sits exactly opposite to Erica. Bablu sits to the immediate left of Himan facing south. Pawan sits exactly opposite to Chaman.Who sits exactly opposite to Himan?

(A) Erica
(B) Chaman
(C) Bablu
(D) Manoj

Q.15

By interchanging the given two signs, which of the following equations will NOT be correct? + and ×; I. 180 – 32 + 3 × 148 ÷ 37 = 88; II. 204 ÷ 17 × 23 + 5 – 97 = 50

(A) Both I and II
(B) Only I
(C) Neither I nor II
(D) Only II

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'ISHTY' is written as '15789', 'PLEM' is written as '2304' and 'QPT' is written as '628' . Which word will be coded as '63781' in that code language?

(A) QTLSP
(B) PETYL
(C) QLHTI
(D) THLPS

Q.17

Five girls A, B, C, Z and U are sitting in a row, facing towards the south (but not necessarily in the same order). No one is sitting to the right of A. Three girls are sitting to the left of U. B is second to the left of C. Who is sitting second to the left of U?

(A) U
(B) Z
(C) A
(D) B

Q.18

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 17, 25, 52, 116, 241, ?

(A) 457
(B) 467
(C) 461
(D) 447

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. POND : WMLK :: RAMP : ?

(A) KZNI
(B) KMZI
(C) KNZI
(D) IZNK

Q.23

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (68, 46, 22) (242, 160, 82)

(A) (108, 75, 33)
(B) (38, 12, 18)
(C) (176, 55, 148)
(D) (88, 24, 48)

Q.24

In a certain code language, 'GBTMS' is written as 'HNGYT' and 'PONDEK' is written as 'PVWMLK'. How will 'VIGOUR' be written in that code language?

(A) IELTRF
(B) ILFTRE
(C) IFLTRE
(D) ILETRF

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Snake : Reptile :: Frog : Amphibian :: Orchid : ?

(A) Petals
(B) Animal
(C) Stem
(D) Flower

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Who was the Governor-General of India when the permanent settlement was introduced in 1793?

(A) Warren Hastings
(B) Charles Cornwallis
(C) Thomas Munro
(D) Robert Clive

Q.2
Which of the following is/are example(s) of cold-blooded animals? I. Turtles; II. Snakes

(A) Both I and II
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Only I
(D) Only II

Q.3
The Mahakali Caves are a group of 19 rock cut monuments located in _____.

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) West Bengal

Q.4
Who is the author of the book 'Defending India'?

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Pranab Mukherjee
(C) Jaswant Singh
(D) Sitaram Yechury

Q.5
In which year did Mahatma Gandhi lead a successful mill workers strike in Ahmedabad?

(A) 1917
(B) 1918
(C) 1916
(D) 1919

Q.6
How many states and union territories of India did the Census 2011 cover?

(A) 40
(B) 45
(C) 28
(D) 35

Q.7
Which of the following rights is NOT a fundamental right under the Indian Constitution?

(A) Right to Equality
(B) Right Against Exploitation
(C) Right to Freedom
(D) Right to Property

Q.9
'Maach' is the traditional theatre form of which Indian state?

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Karnataka
(C) Nagaland
(D) Assam

Q.10
Tsomgo Lake is a glacial lake located in which of the following states?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Punjab
(C) Sikkim
(D) Gujarat

Q.11
What chemical element does 'N' stand for in the periodic table?

(A) Neptunium
(B) Nitrogen
(C) Neon
(D) Neodymium

Q.12
Which of the following commissions is mentioned in the Indian Constitution?

(A) Union Public Service Commission
(B) National Commission for Women
(C) Competition Commission of India
(D) National Human Rights Commission

Q.13
With which of the following musical instruments was Pandit Ravi Shankar primarily associated?

(A) Flute
(B) Guitar
(C) Tabla
(D) Sitar

Q.14
The longest National Highway is NH44, which runs from Jammu and Kashmir to _____.

(A) Telangana
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Karnataka

Q.15
Who among the following was voted the ICC player of the Month for February 2022 in Men's category?

(A) Vriitya Arvind
(B) Shreyas Iyer
(C) Dipendra Singh Airee
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.16
Which of the following Indian festivals is celebrated to pay reverence to Lord Jagannath?

(A) Ratha Yatra
(B) Thrissur Pooram
(C) Hemis
(D) Losar

Q.17
Vempati Chinna Satyam was known for which classical dance form?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Bihu
(C) Manipuri
(D) Odissi

Q.18
_____ is the difference between the government's total expenditure and its total receipts, excluding borrowings.

(A) Credit flow
(B) Fiscal deficit
(C) Debt burden
(D) Market equilibrium

Q.19
Who among the following founded the city of Tughlaqabad?

(A) Ala-ud-din Khilji
(B) Ghiyas ud-din Tughluq
(C) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
(D) Muhammad bin Tughluq

Q.20
Which cricket player won the Man of the Series Award for T20I series on Sri Lanka tour of India, 2022?

(A) Rishabh Pant
(B) Avesh Khan
(C) Shreyas Iyer
(D) Mohammad Siraj

Q.21
Who among the following won the BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year Award 2021?

(A) Lovlina Borgohain
(B) Mirabai Chanu
(C) Aditi Ashok
(D) PV Sindhu

Q.22
Banabhatta was the court poet of _____.

(A) Harshavardhana
(B) Ashoka
(C) Kumaragupta
(D) Bindusara

Q.23

Which of the following are the two island neighbours of India?

(A) Sri Lanka and Maldives
(B) Philippines and Sri Lanka
(C) Taiwan and Singapore
(D) New Zealand and Maldives

Q.24

When the bread rises and bakes, _____creates thousands of bubbles in the dough.

(A) phosphorus
(B) nitrogen
(C) oxygen
(D) carbon dioxide

Q.25

The _____ was presented by Nirmala Sitharaman on 1 February 2022, proposing various changes in the provisions of Income Tax Act, 1961 (the Act).

(A) Appropriation Bill
(B) Finance Bill
(C) Mediation Bill
(D) Indian Antarctic Bill

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Footpath

A peanut seller's stove stands on the 'footpath', the pavement just outside the shops, which is why it brings a street scene to mind.

Q.2 · Answer (A) happened

'Yesterday' calls for the simple past: 'I happened to be on a street', that is, I was there by chance.

Q.3 · Answer (C) To prepare oneself for a difficult situation

To 'gird up your loins' is to get ready for something difficult or demanding.

Q.4 · Answer (C) sufficient

'Sufficient' means enough: three hours should be enough time to finish. 'Majestic', 'voluminous' and 'grand' describe size or splendour, not time.

Q.5 · Answer (C) because

The second clause gives the reason for walking out, so the conjunction is 'because'. 'But' and 'yet' show contrast.

Q.6 · Answer (A) how badly

'Wanted' is a verb, so it takes the adverb 'badly', not the adjective 'bad': 'He knows how badly I wanted a baby.'

Q.7 · Answer (A) that giving off

The relative clause needs a finite verb: 'The thin wire that gives off light is called the filament.'

Q.8 · Answer (B) stimulate

To 'encourage' is to give someone support or confidence, close to 'stimulate', to rouse to action. 'Daunt', 'undermine' and 'abate' all weaken or discourage.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Penetrate

'Penetrate' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'livelihood', 'veritable' and 'purposefully'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Vigorous

'Emphatic' means forceful and clear, so 'vigorous' is closest. 'Restrained', 'hesitant' and 'moderate' are nearly its opposite.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Fluke

A 'fluke' is a lucky chance. A pauper is a very poor person, a messiah a saviour and a masquerade a pretence or a masked ball.

Q.12 · Answer (C) course

One enrols for a 'course' of study. 'Coarse' means rough, 'caws' are the cries of crows and a 'cause' is a reason or an aim.

Q.13 · Answer (C) No substitution required

The sentence is already right: the present passive 'how it is processed' matches 'is determined' and 'is grown'. The '-ing' forms would make the plant do the processing, and 'was' breaks the present tense.

Q.14 · Answer (B) A shocking revelation

An 'eye-opener' is something surprising that reveals a truth one had not known, so 'a shocking revelation' is the closest of the options.

Q.15 · Answer (C) little

'Little' here is an adjective meaning small or young: 'A little girl is missing.' 'Few' goes with plural nouns and 'less' with uncountable ones, and 'so' cannot qualify a noun this way.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Obvious
'Obscure' means unclear or little known, so its opposite is 'obvious', easily seen or understood.

Q.18 · Answer (B) was reluctant to have their pictures take
In the causative 'have' + object, the verb that follows is the past participle: 'to have their pictures taken', not 'take'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) We needing to kept
The subject 'we' needs a finite verb, and 'to' takes the base form: 'We need to keep a close eye on the rising prices of fuel.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) Adhere
To 'adhere to' practices is to follow them closely, which is what farmers are urged to do.

Q.21 · Answer (C) at
The time of day takes 'at' in 'at night'.

Q.22 · Answer (B) before
Devices go off at least 30 minutes 'before' getting into bed. 'Former', 'previous' and 'latter' are adjectives and cannot introduce 'getting into bed' here.

Q.24 · Answer (B) down
To 'write down' a list is to put it on paper.

Q.25 · Answer (C) following
A to-do list is made for the 'following' day, the next one. 'Previous' and 'preceding' point backwards and 'present' to today.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) ÷ and +
After interchanging ÷ and +: 6 + 24 ÷ 6 × 7 − 5 = 6 + 28 − 5 = 29.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Both conclusions I and II follows.
All brothers are sisters, all sisters are wives and all wives are sons, so all brothers are sons: I follows. As all wives are sons, some sons are wives: II follows too.

Q.3 · Answer (C) JR
Each letter moves 3 places forward: C → F, R → U, I → L and so on. So G → J and O → R: JR.

Q.4 · Answer (D) QFW
Each letter moves 5 places forward: T → Y, O → T, N → S. So L → Q, A → F, R → W: QFW.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 121
The differences are 10, 14, 18, 22, rising by 4 each time. The next is 26: 95 + 26 = 121.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Suresh
Raman is the tallest, Tinku second (shorter than only one), Puneet third (two are shorter than him) and Qazir fourth (taller than only one), which leaves Suresh the shortest.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Only conclusions I and II follow
As no X is C, no C is X, so some C are not X: I follows. The A that are not C may or may not be X, so 'some A are X' is possible: II follows. Nothing says every C is an A, so III does not follow.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 109
Each second number is three times the first plus 1: 16 × 3 + 1 = 49 and 18 × 3 + 1 = 55. So 36 × 3 + 1 = 109.

Q.11 · Answer (D) HLMT
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y and so on): H → S, O → L, R → I, N → M, S → H. So S → H, O → L, N → M, G → T: HLMT.

Q.12 · Answer (C) ALUG
Each letter moves 2 places back from one cluster to the next: G, E, C, A; R, P, N, L; A, Y, W, U; M, K, I, G. The next cluster is ALUG.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Manoj
Bablu is to Himan's immediate left in the south-facing row, and Chaman is in the same row but not next to Himan, so Bablu sits in the middle with Himan and Chaman at the ends. Erica faces Bablu and Pawan faces Chaman, so Manoj faces Himan.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Only II
After interchanging + and ×: I. 180 – 32 × 3 + 148 ÷ 37 = 180 – 96 + 4 = 88, which is correct; II. 204 ÷ 17 + 23 × 5 – 97 = 12 + 115 – 97 = 30, not 50. So only II is not correct.

Q.16 · Answer (C) QLHTI
T is in 'ISHTY' and 'QPT', and P in 'PLEM' and 'QPT', so 8 = T and 2 = P, which leaves 6 = Q: each word is coded letter by letter in order. Then I = 1, S = 5, H = 7 and L = 3, so 63781 is QLHTI.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Z
Left and right are the girls' own. A is at the right end and U has three girls to her left, so U sits next to A. B is two places to the left of C in the remaining three seats, so from the right the order is A, U, C, Z, B, and Z is second to the left of U.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 457
The differences are 8, 27, 64, 125, the cubes of 2, 3, 4 and 5. The next is $6^3 = 216$: 241 + 216 = 457.

Q.22 · Answer (C) KNZI
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet and the cluster reversed: POND → KLMW → WMLK. So RAMP → IZNK → KNZI.

Q.23 · Answer (A) (108, 75, 33)
In each set the first number is the sum of the other two: 46 + 22 = 68 and 160 + 82 = 242. Likewise 75 + 33 = 108.

Q.24 · Answer (C) IFLTRE
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet and the word reversed: GBTMS → TYGNH → HNGYT and PONDEK → KLMWVP → PVWMLK. So VIGOUR → ERTLFI → IFLTRE.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Flower
Each pair names a member and its class: a snake is a reptile and a frog an amphibian, and an orchid is a flower.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Charles Cornwallis
Lord (Charles) Cornwallis, Governor-General from 1786 to 1793, introduced the Permanent Settlement of land revenue in Bengal, Bihar and Odisha in 1793.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Both I and II
Turtles and snakes are reptiles, which are cold-blooded: their body temperature changes with their surroundings.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Maharashtra
The Mahakali (Kondivite) Caves, 19 Buddhist rock-cut caves in two groups, are in Andheri East, Mumbai, in Maharashtra.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Jaswant Singh
'Defending India' (1999), a book on India's security, is by Jaswant Singh.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 1918
In 1918 Gandhi led the Ahmedabad cotton mill workers in their dispute over wages and fasted in their support, his first hunger strike in India.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 35
Census 2011 covered 35 states and union territories, 28 states and 7 union territories, before Telangana was formed in 2014.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Right to Property
The 44th Amendment (1978) removed the right to property from the Fundamental Rights; it is now a constitutional right under Article 300A.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Madhya Pradesh
Maach is a musical folk theatre of the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Sikkim
Tsomgo (Changu) Lake is a glacial lake in East Sikkim, on the road from Gangtok to the Nathu La pass.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Nitrogen
N is nitrogen, atomic number 7. Neon is Ne, neptunium Np and neodymium Nd.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Union Public Service Commission
The UPSC is a constitutional body, provided for in Articles 315-323. The National Commission for Women, the Competition Commission of India and the National Human Rights Commission were set up under Acts of Parliament.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Sitar
Pandit Ravi Shankar was a sitar player, a Bharat Ratna (1999) who took Hindustani classical music to audiences around the world.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Tamil Nadu
NH44, the longest national highway when the exam was held (July 2022), runs north to south from Srinagar to Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Shreyas Iyer
Shreyas Iyer was voted ICC Men's Player of the Month for February 2022, a month in which he made 80 in an ODI against the West Indies and 204 runs without being dismissed in the T20I series against Sri Lanka. UAE's Vriitya Aravind and Nepal's Dipendra Singh Airee were the other nominees.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Ratha Yatra
The Ratha Yatra at Puri, Odisha, takes Lord Jagannath with Balabhadra and Subhadra out in huge chariots. Thrissur Pooram is a Kerala temple festival, and Hemis and Losar are Buddhist festivals.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Kuchipudi
Vempati Chinna Satyam was a Kuchipudi guru who founded the Kuchipudi Art Academy in Chennai.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Fiscal deficit
Fiscal deficit = total expenditure – total receipts excluding borrowings; it shows how much the government must borrow.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Ghiyas ud-din Tughluq
Ghiyas-ud-din Tughluq, founder of the Tughluq dynasty, built the fortified city of Tughlaqabad in Delhi in the 1320s.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Shreyas Iyer
Shreyas Iyer was Player of the Series in India's 3-0 T20I win over Sri Lanka in February 2022, scoring 57, 74 and 73, all not out.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Mirabai Chanu
The weightlifter Mirabai Chanu, silver medallist at the Tokyo Olympics, won the BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year award for 2021, announced in March 2022.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Harshavardhana
Banabhatta was the court poet of Harshavardhana in the 7th century; he wrote the 'Harshacharita', Harsha's biography, and 'Kadambari'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Sri Lanka and Maldives
Sri Lanka, across the Palk Strait, and the Maldives, south of Lakshadweep, are India's island neighbours.

Q.24 · Answer (D) carbon dioxide
Yeast ferments the sugars in the dough and gives off carbon dioxide, whose bubbles make the bread rise.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Finance Bill
The Finance Bill, introduced with the Union Budget, carries the government's tax proposals; the Finance Bill 2022, presented on 1 February 2022, proposed changes to the Income Tax Act.

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